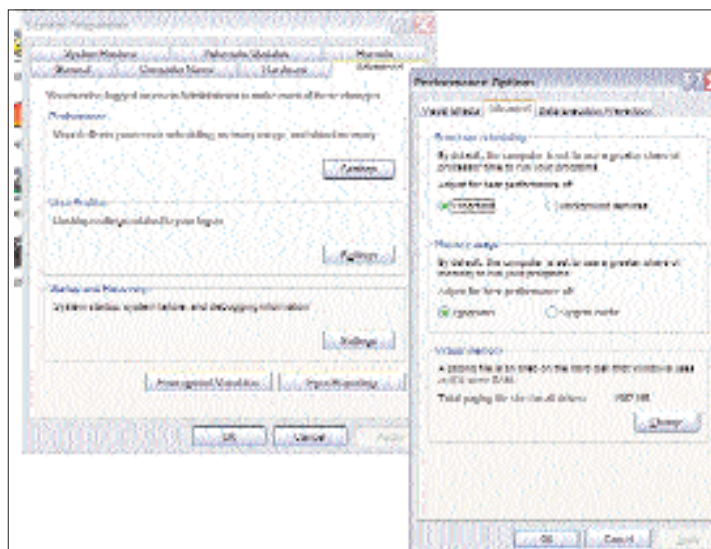


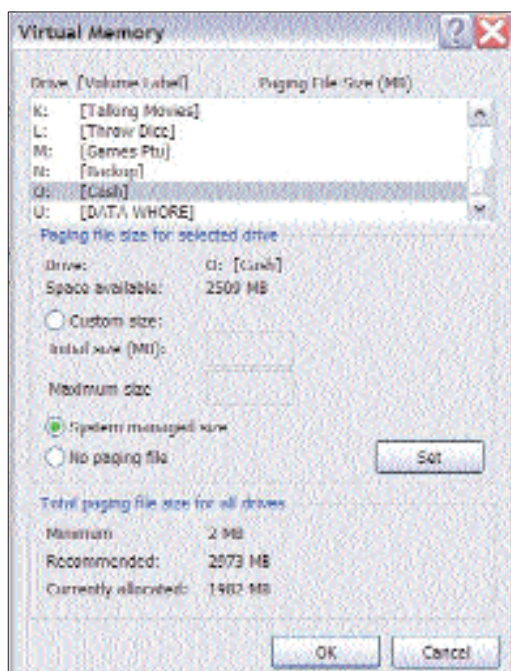


Click on the Change button under the Virtual Memory section to change your Windows XP system cache

Here, click on the Advanced tab once more and under Virtual Memory, click on Change.

Here, note that you can assign a cache file to any of your partitions, remove it from under the Windows partition, and assign it to the one you created. You can either ask Windows to manage the size of this partition, or you can specify the amount allocated. Giving the cache an Initial size and a Maximum size equal to the size of the partition will create a permanent, non-dynamic cache, which improves performance a bit (for example, if the partition is 2 GB, assign 2 GB as the Initial and the Maximum). Click on Set and then Apply these changes. The system will reboot to the new settings.

While we're on a drive to creating new partitions, add one to back up your most important data to. This partition could store data



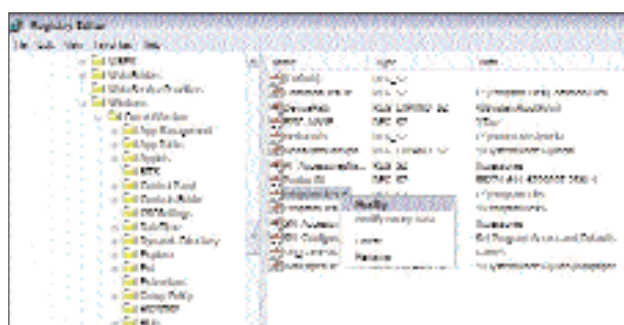
Assigning a partition as your system's cache

such as your Outlook PST files, your bookmarks, your contacts, your RSS OPML collections, your music/video library backup, your picture library backup, and so on. A 2 GB backup partition of this nature should suit most needs.

Moving The Program Files Folder

While moving your Documents folder is just a right-click job, Programs Files takes a bit more elbow grease to get moving. A very important thing to remember is that you will need to do this immediately after a system install for maximum benefit. We are going to do this via a Registry edit: the edit will essentially move the default path to your Program Files to the new location specified. It will not move the contents of the default folder (which is under C: or XP's install drive). What this ensures is that programs that you install in the future will be stored in the new location. This is why it is important to make this change as soon as you finish installing Windows XP.

To access the Registry Editor, click on Start > Run and then type "regedit" in the Run dialog box, and hit [Enter] to run the program. To locate the key we're looking for, press [Ctrl] + [F] and enter ProgramFilesDir in the "Find what" field. This is generally located under this path: HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE > SOFTWARE > MICROSOFT > Windows > Current Version > ProgramFilesDir. You can now right-click on ProgramFilesDir and click on Modify to change its Value data to the new path you want.



Changing the path to your Program Files must be done immediately after installation for best results

A View To Change

Windows XP can showcase your folders in a variety of ways, each suited to its contents. These settings can be accessed from under Windows Explorer: look under the View menu. Here we are interested in the "Arrange Icons By" sub-menu and the Thumbnails, Tiles, Icons, List, and Details options.

The View > Thumbnails option is perhaps of the greatest benefit. It should be used to showcase two types of folders—your pictures folder and your music folder. Applying this view to a folder containing pictures will display your photos as thumbnails, allowing you to open one based on what it represents instead of having to recall its filename. And if you categorise your music into artist and albums, you can represent music folders by either the album art or the artist's profile photo. Click on Choose Picture under the Folder Pictures section to choose a